

Matthew Saunders

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Summary

Senior Computer Science student with extensive programming skills, hardware knowledge, scientific research skills, and a deep passion for space and aeronautical sciences. Thrives on solving complex problems through analytical and critical thinking while staying curious and committed to learning. Team-oriented with excellent communication and collaboration skills. Ready to apply technical skills, grow, prosper, and kickstart a career in the professional world.

Education

University of Maryland Global Campus, Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Math Focus, April 2027

Relevant Coursework: Discrete Structures, Software Development, Advanced Programming, Compiler Theory, ML, Calculus I, II, III, Linear Algebra, Differential Equations, Algebraic Structures, Real Analysis, Complex Analysis

University of Colorado, Boulder, Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, August 2022 - April 2023

Relevant Coursework: Astronomy, Ethics, Philosophy, General Education Credits

Sollers Point Technical High School, Technical Certificate in Computer Science, September 2017 - May 2021

Relevant Coursework: Computer Architecture, Algorithm Design, Microcontrollers, Networking

Sparrows Point High School, High School Diploma, September 2017 - May 2021

Certifications

NASA, Open Science Essentials, obtained August 2026

Relevant Coursework: Open Science Framework, Source Control, Open Data, Documentation, Contribution, Development

NASA, Open Science 101, obtained August 2026

Relevant Coursework: Open Source Ethics, Open Results, Research, Licensing

Skills

Languages: C, C++, C#, Rust, ASM, Python, Swift, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, HTML, CSS

Frameworks: React.js, Node.js, Next.js, SwiftUI, NumPy, Tesseract, Matplotlib, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Pandas

Developer Tools: Amazon Web Services, PostgreSQL, Oracle SQL, Docker, Firebase, GitHub, Jira, Flex, Make

Operating Systems: Windows, macOS, Linux, Unix

Technical: Computer Hardware, Computer Software, MATLAB, Soldering, Embedded Programming, Networking

Projects

Mobile Computerized Automated Telescope, C, Python, Embedded Programming, Tesseract, Linux

Newtonian reflector telescope designed to track space objects or any other moving object. Made for astrophotography.

- Built with aluminum extrusion and a 4.5-inch spherical primary mirror. Utilizes primary mirror focusing and shifting.
- Uses a Raspberry Pi for motor control, sensing, and running Pi Finder for celestial object tracking.
- Main camera uses a Sony ZVE-10, which allows for a 6000 X 4000 resolution and multiple hour-long exposures.

GoDash iOS app, <https://godash.us/>, Swift, SwiftUI, macOS, iOS

An iOS dash cam app that allows the user to use maps and music while also recording with the iPhone camera.

- Utilizing a hands-free phone mount, the phone records a looping video over the dashboard out of the windshield.
- Recording loop time up to 10 minutes. Other features include crash/hard brake detection and telemetry overlays.
- Interface employs distraction-free multitasking using half-screen modules for Apple Maps and Apple Music.

Tiny PKMS and IDE, <https://github.com/mattsaunder/tiny>, Rust, TUI, Git

An extremely lightweight, terminal-based personal knowledge management system, IDE, and text editor. Written in Rust.

- Max installation size of 8.2MB. Supports editing plain text, Markdown files, and 212 programming languages.
- Full configuration for color, window size, key bindings, and syntax highlighting. Works in any terminal.
- The project map feature displays the project contents on a pane with arrows showing file links like function calls.

Cosmos.js, <https://github.com/mattsaunder/cosmos.js>, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Python, Git

An ASCII art generator that generates animated ASCII planets and exports Python and JavaScript for any project.

- Fully hosted on a static site with zero plugins or frameworks. Can be hosted locally. Runs in any browser.
- Uses a ray-cast model to dictate the lighting and shading using a Bourke character ramp. Texturing is random.
- The program exports its own code it's using for the planet preview that can be copied and pasted to any project.

Work Experience

Micro Center, System Sales Associate, Parkville, Maryland, November 2024 - April 2025

- Managed full solution tech sales including hardware, software, and warranties to individuals and business clients.
- Created a needs analysis for every client to fit in with the system requirements and budget constraints.
- Worked in parallel with the IT team to allow seamless data transfers, system setups, and custom-built systems.
- Maintained up-to-date knowledge of the newest advancements in technology. Ex. NPUs, ARM, AI.

BMW Group, Client Advisor and Lease Manager, Towson, Maryland, January 2023 - May 2024

- Controlled client acquisition, client relations, deal building, and closing of performance and high-end cars.
- Surpassed monthly goal of 12 deals and always maintained a client book of over 100 clients.
- Promoted to lease manager and increased recurring customer lease numbers by over 60% using equity mining tools.
- Created overseas orders and facilitated custom imports from Germany to the port of Baltimore.

Best Buy, Sales Associate, White Marsh, Maryland - Boulder, Colorado, November 2020 - May 2022

- Managed consumer sales of phones, computers, printers, TVs, and appliances.
- Excelled in selling Best Buy Total Tech on transactions by building rapport with customers.
- Communicated with outside companies for telecommunication service contracts and warranty repair orders.
- Obtained technology training, allowing me to work in every department Best Buy offers.

Extracurricular and Volunteer Work

Boy Scouts of America, Star Scout, obtained in 2017

Volunteer work: Scouting for Food, Wreaths Across America, State Park/roadway cleanup projects, Astronomy Teacher

The Planetary Society, Member, Mariner

Interests

Astrophotography, Aerospace, Computer Building, Camping, Hiking, Traveling, Rock Climbing, Music, Movies